

Teo Mendoza

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Portfolio - teomendoza.github.io

Education

Willamette University
B.S. in Computer Science
GPA: 3.95

Expected Graduation: Fall 2026

Projects

Birthright – Roguelike Deckbuilder & 1v1 Online Card Battler

- Designed and developed Birthright, a roguelike deckbuilder built around strategy and utility over raw power, capping card costs at 5 gold, resetting each turn so no single card or turn can dominate the fight.
- Built the entire content system fully data-driven, using enum-based dynamic dispatch throughout the codebase to resolve behavior generically, so adding new content requires zero code changes, only new data.
- Enforced server-gated view permissions in Rust using SpacetimeDB, so each client only ever receives the subset of game state it's authorized to see, computed server-side per connection.
- Shipped a playable 1v1 multiplayer mode on itch.io, running on the same core as the solo roguelike, growing an early playerbase to 50 players and counting through iterative updates and player feedback.

Work Experience

Contract Game Developer – KHV Games

May 2026 – August 2026

- Sole backend developer on a 3-person team building an online RPG in Rust using SpacetimeDB, architecting the foundational data-driven systems the rest of the team built content on.
- Designed a component-based enemy AI framework composing attack and movement patterns into arbitrary behavior sequences, enabling teammates to build unique enemies without writing new code.
- Built a data-driven pipeline with enum-based dynamic dispatch powering the game's item and inventory system.
- Implemented client-server synchronization under a server-authoritative model, alongside foundational anti-cheat logging for anomaly detection.

Pedalogical – Project Manager & Backend Developer

May 2025 – August 2025

- Led a 3-person team building Pedalogical, an NSF-funded AI-adaptive learning platform deployed across multiple university courses, supporting 150 students, built on ASP.NET, EF Core, and PostgreSQL.
- Designed an adaptive AI feedback pipeline that synthesizes student interaction history and profile data into compressed context for each LLM call, enabling personalized, instructor-configurable feedback while significantly reducing storage and inference overhead.
- Built analytics and interaction-logging systems capturing student engagement and learning data, powering instructor-facing dashboards with aggregated insights.
- Researched and tuned LLM guardrails grounded in learning-science principles (e.g. Zone of Proximal Development) to keep AI feedback within instructor-defined difficulty and depth, guiding students toward understanding without giving away answers.

Resident Advisor – Willamette University

August 2024 – May 2025

- Supervised a community of 50 residents and collaborated with staff to support a housing population of 600+ students.
- Mediated conflicts, enforced university policies, and responded to crises to maintain a safe and structured living environment.
- Planned and led weekly programs and large-scale monthly events to foster community engagement and student well-being.

Skills

Game Design: Multiplayer Game Design, Combat & Ability Design, Card Design, Economy Design

Backend Engineering: Server-Authoritative Architecture, Systems Design, Multiplayer Networking, Prompt Engineering, LLM API Integration, Agentic Development (Claude Code)

Programming: Rust, C#, SQL, Python, GDScript, Bash

Tools: Unity, Godot, SpacetimeDB, ASP.NET, EF Core, Docker, Git/GitHub, PostgreSQL

Publications

Mendoza, T., et al. (2025). *Not All Chatbots Teach: Evidence for Pedagogical Design in AI-Assisted Technical Education*. ACM SIGCITE 2025.